DA Timer Help

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What DA Timer does

DA Timer is a show timer for a broadcast Director's Assistant. It runs two clocks: a **segment** clock for the current item and a **program** clock for the whole show. It tells you whether you're over or under on each segment and in total.

It can also back-time to a hard out, keep a log of notes, mark times you can export to Excel, and put the clocks on a second screen for the presenter or floor. It runs on Windows and Mac, and can be driven from a Stream Deck.

The main screen

The top card is the segment clock and the bottom card is the program clock. Each card's coloured bar on the left goes green when that clock is running.

Button	What it does
ALL START / ALL STOP	Starts or stops both clocks together
START / STOP (on a card)	Starts or stops just that clock
NEXT (segment card)	Ends the current segment, records its time in the running order, and starts the next one from zero
RESET (program card)	Clears both clocks and the segment times, ready for a new show (asks first; Undo brings it back)
PRESET	Types in a time, e.g. if you started late; works while the clock is running

Under each clock, the goal and “left” or “over” readout turns amber in the last 15 seconds of a segment and red once it's over. The toolbar along the bottom opens everything else.

Features

Each of these is in the toolbar, and you can switch off any you don't need in **Settings**.

Feature	What it's for
Running order	Lists each segment with its goal, actual time, +/− and start-by time
Goals & hard out	Set a goal for each segment (or paste them from Excel), how many segments the show has (for "segments left"), and a hard out: an off-air time or a total program length
Back-timing	With a hard out set, a band shows time to out, projected length and how much to cut or spare
Log	Type a note (the time is stamped when you start typing) or press Mark; each entry records the time of day and program time. **Export to Excel** saves it
Clock	Shows the time of day in the header
Output to monitor	Puts a clean full-screen clock display on a second monitor for the presenter or floor, with "Segment 3 of 8 · 5 left" and an optional time-of-day or timecode clock. The ▾ next to Output to monitor picks the monitor, and Layout, sizes and colours chooses what shows, how big, what colour and in what order, per show. Arrange there lays the screen out Stacked (rows down the screen) or Side by side (segment and program clocks next to each other), or you can drag anything in the preview to put it where you like (Custom). Drag the small square in a box's corner to resize it. The segment clock there can count down to its goal, then up in red when over. The mouse pointer hides on the output after 2 seconds. For a video overlay instead of a monitor, the same ▾ → Video overlay (OBS / vMix) gives an address to add as a browser source (1920 × 1080): a transparent timing bar along the bottom of the picture. Design video overlay (same menu) picks what it shows and in what order, text sizes, colours, a logo, position and fonts, separately from the monitor

Feature	What it's for
No show	For between shows, rehearsals and breaks: the output monitor shows only a big time of day, and the video overlay shows only its time-of-day block. Your layout is untouched; tap No show again to bring everything back. Talent messages still show on top. Logged, and Stream Deck (Display Toggle → No show) and Companion (noshow_toggle, noshow_on, noshow_off) can switch it too.
Show	Saves each show's name, logos, titles and colours, so you can switch between shows
Stream Deck	Plug a Stream Deck in and DA Timer drives it directly. Or use the Elgato plugin
Time source	Uses the computer clock, network time (NTP) or LTC timecode from an audio input
Undo	Undoes the last action, including an accidental reset, without losing time on the clocks
Message	Sends a talent cue such as WRAP UP or 30 SECONDS. Tap a preset (right-click one to change it) or type your own and press Enter. It shows big across the top of the output monitor, and on the video overlay if you switch that on. Pick a colour, turn flashing on or off, and choose to clear it yourself or after 10 s, 30 s or 1 min. Esc or Clear removes it. Each message is written to the log, and Stream Deck or Companion can send and clear messages too. Turn the button on in Settings if you can't see it.

While a clock runs, DA Timer keeps the computer from sleeping or blanking the screen. If it closes unexpectedly mid-show, it offers to restore the clocks and log when you reopen it.

Warnings and safety

- **Not saved since hh:mm** (red, bottom right): DA Timer couldn't save its log, settings or a show, usually because the disk is full or antivirus or OneDrive is locking its folder. The clocks keep running. Click the warning to see what failed and where the data

folder is. If a file is ever damaged, DA Timer keeps a copy with ".damaged" in its name instead of starting empty over it.

- **Quit Elgato app** (amber): the Elgato Stream Deck app and DA Timer's direct USB mode are both trying to drive the deck. Quit the Elgato app, or turn off Stream Deck (direct USB) in Settings and use the Elgato plugin instead. This now works on Mac as well as Windows.
- **After a crash or power cut**, DA Timer offers to restore the clocks and segment times when it next opens. Say yes, and running clocks include the time it was closed.
- **Video overlay on another computer**: the address DA Timer shows ends in ?key=… Copy the whole address; without the key the overlay is refused. Other computers can only view, never control.
- **Stream Deck and Companion** commands only work from the DA Timer computer itself. Web pages can't send commands or read the show's details.

Keyboard shortcuts

Single-key shortcuts don't fire while you're typing a note, and can be switched off in Settings.

Key (Windows)	Key (Mac)	Does
Space	Space	Start / stop both clocks
N	N	Next segment
D	D	Output to monitor on / off
L	L	Running order on / off
T	T	Time-of-day clock on / off
G	G	Goals & hard out
F2	F2 (fn+F2)	Type a log note
Ctrl+M	Cmd+M	Log a mark
Ctrl+Z	Cmd+Z	Undo
Ctrl+,	Cmd+,	Settings
F11 / Esc	fn+F11 / Esc	Full screen GUI on / off (or the Full screen GUI button)

First launch on a Mac

macOS blocks DA Timer the first time because it isn't signed with a paid Apple developer certificate. Allow it once per Mac, and again after each new version. You'll need the Mac's login password or Touch ID.

1. Drag **DA Timer.app** into **Applications**, then double-click it. When the "Not Opened" warning appears, click **Done** (not Move to Trash).
2. Open **System Settings** → **Privacy & Security**.
3. Scroll down to **Security**. Next to **"DA Timer" was blocked to protect your Mac**, click **Open Anyway**.
4. In the next warning, click **Open Anyway** again.
5. Enter your password or use Touch ID. DA Timer opens, and opens normally from then on.

If **Open Anyway** isn't there, double-click DA Timer again, then go back to Privacy & Security. The button only appears for a while after a blocked attempt.